

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, January 14, 2026, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor William Greenrose
Ward III Councilor Christopher Irish
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Christopher Cogswell
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Nancy Bates, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

Mayor Girard removed item B. The Abenaki Tribe will make a presentation later in the year.

Item H. Main Street Strategy and Development Discussion was also removed.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Irish to suspend Council Rules and add two non-publics 91-A :3 II(a) and 91-A :3 II(c) before New Business.

Roll call:

**O’Hearne – no
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – no
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes**

Motion carried 7-2

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept the minutes of the December 10, 2026, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – abstain

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – abstain

Girard – yes

Motion carried 7-0, 2 abstained

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Hemingway to accept the minutes of the December 17, 2026, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – abstain

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – abstain

Girard – yes

Motion carried 7-0, 2 abstained

MAYOR’S NOTES

Mayor Girard noted Arrowhead Recreation will be closed this weekend due to not having enough snow.

Parks and Recreation will hold the Pigskin 5K on February 8th at 11am.

CITY MANAGER’S REPORT

Manager Bates reported on the Eversource PSNH tax abatement case, there was a settlement order issued by the court, but need to wait for the appeal period to be over and is estimating that to be 60-90 days. Rough calculations came to \$100,000 including interest which is substantially lower than anticipated once this refund is paid out anything above the settlement will drop back into fund balance.

Still waiting on the 17 Water Street final legal costs, once received Manager Bates will report on the total net profit.

There is a vacancy for the Planning and Development Director.

Next Council meeting on January 28th, Manager Bates will be on vacation, Chief Chamberlain will be stepping up as Acting City Manager.

Councilor Koloski had concerns with the municipal parking lot across from City Hall and asked when it was paved, and shared concern for the cracks in the lot and mentioned a citizen complained of their car bottoming out.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Claremont Development Authority

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to re-appoint Martha Maki to Seat 4 on the Claremont Development Authority.

Voice vote:

O'Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to re-appoint David Finnerty to Seat 5 on the Claremont Development Authority.

Voice vote:

O'Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

**Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0**

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to appoint Felicia Brych Dalke to Seat 6 on the Claremont Development Authority.

**Voice vote:
O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0**

Licensing Board

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to re-appoint Ian Carswell to Seat 3 on the Licensing Board.

**Voice vote:
O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0**

Claremont Police Commission

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to nominate Bernard Dube Sr. to Seat 3 on the Licensing Board.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Irish to nominate Chris Shaban to Seat 3 on the Licensing Board.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – Dube

Cogswell – Dube

Greenrose – Dube

Matteau – Dube

Koloski – Dube

Limoges – Dube

Hemingway – Dube

Irish – Shaban

Girard – Dube

Motion carried 8-1 Dube

Council Appointments

Frances J. Tolles Home

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to appoint Councilor O’Hearne to the Frances J. Tolles Home Committee.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Claremont Arts, History and Culture Resources

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Hemingway to appoint Councilor Koloski to the Claremont Arts, History Culture Resources.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

CCTV

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to appoint Councilor Cogswell to the CCTV Board.

Voice vote:
O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Policy Committee will be an Agenda item at the first meeting in February.

CITIZEN’S FORUM

Mayor Girard gave reminder that Citizen’s forum is designed to allow you the opportunity to make the Council aware of your concerns. Please state your name and ward number, we ask you to address your concerns directly to the Council. The Council Manager will not be responding to you during this time. You are limited to five minutes on any non-agenda items. In the back of the room please write down your contact information if you’d like to be contacted as well as your concern on the clipboard for follow-up.

No one spoke; Mayor Girard closed the public forum.

OLD BUSINESS

Resolution 2026-26 – Use of Sewer Department Fund Balance – Public Hearing

Director Gleeson explained authorizing use of unrestricted fund balance to pay for the transmission repair of the loader at the wastewater treatment plant.

RESOLUTION 2026-26

Use of Fund Balance – WWTP Loader Repair

WHEREAS the City Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire (the “City Council”) previously approved funding for the maintenance and repair of the Loader at the Waste Water Treatment Plant in FY25. This repair was approved by the Council to lengthen the life of loader with a transmission replacement in lieu of purchasing a new loader; and

WHEREAS the maintenance for the replacement and repair of the Loaders transmission, totaling \$57,576.46 in labor and parts costs, was not completed until FY26;

BE IT RESOLVED by the City Council, after public hearing duly noticed, that it hereby raises and appropriates the amount of \$57,576.46 from the Sewer Department’s Unrestricted fund balance to cover the cost associated with the Waste Water Treatment Plant loader repair;

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the city manager, or her designees, are hereby authorized to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to implement this resolution. *(2/3 Vote Required)*

Dated this 14th day of January, 2026 the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to accept Resolution 2026-26.

Councilor Limoges read Resolution 2026-26 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke; Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – no

Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 8-1

NON-PUBLIC

Non-Members Invited to Attend Nonpublic Session

List by name:

Nancy Bates, City Manager
Shannon Thibodeau, HR Director

Motion to enter Nonpublic Session made by Assistant Mayor Matteau seconded by Councilor Greenrose

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor William Greenrose
Ward III Councilor Christopher Irish
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Christopher Cogswell
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Specific Statutory Reason cited as foundation for the nonpublic session:

RSA 91-A:3, II (a) *The dismissal, promotion, or compensation of any public employee or the disciplining of such employee, or the investigation of any charges against him or her, **unless** the employee affected (1) has a right to a public meeting, and (2) requests that the meeting be open, in which case the request shall be granted.*

Roll Call vote to enter nonpublic session: Majority vote required
List roll

Roll call:
O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Motion: PASSED

Entered nonpublic session at 6:50 p.m.

Description of matters discussed and decisions made (*note: any votes taken in non-public must be by roll call vote, with the vote of each member included in the minutes of the nonpublic session and should be either repeated or disclosed immediately upon exiting non-public session.*)

Did not discuss, will discuss out of non-public.

Motion to leave nonpublic session and return to public session by Councilor O’Hearne, seconded by Councilor Limoges. (Majority vote by roll call.)

List roll

Roll call:
O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Motion: PASSED

Public session reconvened at 7:03 p.m.

These minutes recorded by: Assistant Mayor Matteau

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to suspend Council rules and add an item to the agenda

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – no
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 8-1

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to add Employee Recruitment Discussion after the CDBG Update.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes
Cogswell – yes
Greenrose – yes
Matteau – yes
Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

The second non-public has been cancelled due to the auditor not being in attendance.

Right of Way Off Grissom Lane – Discussion

Manager Bates noted the property owner and representative are looking for a right of way across city owned property. The property is above the wheelabrator site and is currently landlocked.

Jim Ward property representative, and property owner Kim Dyke joined via Zoom and requested a right of way for access to the land locked property.

Council had concerns for long-term maintenance and depreciation.

By consensus Council agreed to proceed and have the owner and representative bring back a Presentation.

Councilor Irish asked for the City Manager to forward this to the Claremont Development Authority.

Resolution 2026-27 Use of Capital Reserve – Building Maintenance and Repair 58 Opera House Square – Public Hearing

RESOLUTION 2026-27

Transfer from Capital Reserves – 58 Opera House Square Maintenance and Repairs

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that

WHEREAS, in 2006, the City established a Capital Reserve Fund for City Facility Repair; and

WHEREAS, the City Council previously approved work to the 58 Opera House Square clock tower; and

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, to raise and appropriate the sum of \$14,610.00 from the City Facility Repair Capital Reserve Fund to pay for part of said repairs (with no impact on the tax rate); and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or her designees, are hereby authorized to make a budget amendment moving \$13,300 from budget line 001-412-412101-0000 Regular Pay to budget line 001-415-415510-0000 Building M&R to cover the remainder of the repair costs (with no impact on the tax rate); and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or her designees, are hereby authorized to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be necessary to implement this resolution. *(2/3 Vote Required)*

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to Accept Resolution 2026-27.

Councilor Koloski read Resolution 2026-27 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Upper Valley Aquatic Use of CSBCC Pool Discussion

Director Martin recommended a collaboration with the Upper Valley Aquatic Center to utilize City pools this would expand aquatic programming within the community and listed financial, Community, and workforce benefits with an additional recommendation the Council to support a lap lane fee and authorize continued discussion to develop a formal agreement.

Councilor Irish stated this was a great idea to collaborate as the pool is something that seems to be underutilized, and could put CSBCC on the map and bring people in.

Councilor Greenrose clarified if there were always going to be lanes open so CSBCC members don't get blocked out, Director Martin replied, yes.

Assistant Mayor Matteau agrees with Councilor Irish and believes this collaboration would be a win/win and is excited to hear this.

Ordinance Change Discussion – Claremont Speedway (City Manager/Licensing Board)

Chief Wilmot representing the Licensing Board is requesting direction from the City Council on the authority of the licensing board specifically on the regulation of motor vehicle racetracks.

This was brought on by an item discussed at a licensing board meeting: the annual license for operations at the Claremont Motor Sports speedway. Upon further review the licensing board does not have authority to regulate specific conditions for motor vehicle racing and the lack of clarity creates challenges to noise, operating hours and accountability.

By consensus Council agrees to move forward with drafting of an ordinance with language for clear authority of the licensing board to regulate licensing of motor vehicle race tracks.

CDBG – Turning Points Planning Study Progress Update - Public Hearing

Mayor Girard mentioned there is an informational document available in the hallway of City Hall on the CDBG Turning Points Planning Study Progress Update.

Mayor Girard then opened a public hearing on the proposed turning point network planning study and read the following script:

Community Development Block Grant funds are available to municipalities through the NH Community Development Finance Authority. Up to \$500,000 annually is available for Economic Development Projects, up to \$500,000 for Housing Projects, up to \$500,000 for Public Facility Projects, up to \$500,000 in Emergency Funds, up to \$25,000 per Planning Study grant. All projects must directly benefit a majority of low

The progress of a \$25,000 in Community Development Block Grant Planning Study for the Turning Points Network (TPN) Residences Study. The CDBG funds, less administration, was sub granted to TPN to study the feasibility of a development of four units of permanent housing at 227 Broad Street for survivors of domestic violence and sexual assault and other situations. The building is currently owned by TPN and is situated adjacent to the recently completed TPN headquarters where TPN offers supportive services to its clientele. The development to be designed to be accessible to individuals with varying needs and will provide TPN with another tool to use in their mission to ensure that everyone, regardless of ability, can access and benefit from the supportive services that they provide. The housing development to be designed with state-of-the-art security measures to ensure the safety and privacy of its residents. The Planning Study grant funds were used for preliminary architectural and engineering, environmental review and related activities.

Banwell NH Inc was selected to perform the study. Preliminary design was completed. w- and moderate-income persons.

This project conforms with Claremont's Housing and Community Development Plan's goals of: Encourage an increase in the supply of good quality housing for households at all income levels,; and Encourage other services that will benefit low and moderate income persons (Short-term and Long-term goal)

Mayor Girard asked for public comment, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Pascale Graham from Turning Points joined the meeting via Zoom and gave an update.

Employee Recruitment Discussion

Manager Bates and Director Thibodeau noted there are problems recruiting because of compensation and is requesting the Council allow the City to subscribe back to LinkedIn as the City was successful last year with much higher success rate than NHMA and Indeed.

Director Thibodeau explained LinkedIn has offered the City a 1-year flat renewal of \$21,870 for year 1, or a multi-year price lock for three years at \$20,776.50 per year.

By consensus Council Agrees to move forward but to comply with policy and come back at a later meeting with a resolution on funding.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

None.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

There was concern about how the Procurement Policy ad hoc committee was formed at the previous council meeting.

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to form an AD HOC Procurement Policy Committee based upon City Manager recommendations to appoint the three councilors: Councilor Greenrose, Councilor Irish, and Councilor Cogswell along with Department of Public Works Director and Assistant Director, City Treasurer and City Manager.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Councilor Koloski shared concern for lights not working in the square. Manager Bates explained this is part of the downtown project and will have a quote coming forward.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None

ADJOURNMENT

At 9:00 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Irish to adjourn.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes
Limoges – yes
Hemingway – yes
Irish – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council